

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting complex disputes, procedural submissions and case preparation at BCLP, and managing matters from instruction to conclusion at Citizens Advice. Experienced in evidence review, drafting procedural documents, preparing hearing bundles and maintaining organised case files under deadline pressure. Strong statutory analysis and legal research skills, developed through contentious work in international arbitration and real estate disputes, and applied daily in a high-volume advisory role.

EDUCATION

- | | |
|---|------------------------------|
| Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit
Queen Mary University of London | Sept 2024 – Oct 2025 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, evidence analysis and legal research• Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions (55); Transnational Law and Governance Applied module covering data privacy and regulatory frameworks (75%) | |
| Law LLB — 2:1
University College London | Sept 2020 – June 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law | |
| International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations
King's College London | Sept 2019 – June 2020 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree) | |

EXPERIENCE

- | | |
|--|----------------------------|
| Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London
Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration | Aug 2023 – Feb 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended substantive sections of the memorial• Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; conducted legal research on disputed issues• Became the sole junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time filing• Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter• Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated translation of Romanian-language materials with an external translator• Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor | |
| Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London
Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes | Feb 2024 – Aug 2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials• Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes• Prepared client notes; maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings and hearing arrangements• Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines; tracked costs and assisted with matter opening and closure | |

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead	July 2026 – Present
--	----------------------------

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from initial instruction through to submission: takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Applies statutory criteria to assess eligibility across welfare benefits, housing and debt matters; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points of law
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, and maintains confidential case records to deadline
- Translates complex statutory requirements into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable clients

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into commercially focused written advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet agreed deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries; communicated amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)**Technical skills:** Legal and commercial research; statutory analysis; documentary review; concise report and advice writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems**Case and evidence management:** Evidence review, hearing bundles, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters